

# LYNETT MAINA

## Full-Stack Software Engineer (Backend-Focused)

Phone: +254 743 288 972 | Email: mainalynett42@gmail.com | Nairobi, Kenya (GMT+3)  
LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/lynettmaina-cybersec | GitHub: github.com/itslynett

### PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack software engineer with hands-on experience building and scaling production systems across backend and frontend, from academic full-stack projects since 2023 through professional roles at Sazara and Royal Media Services. Builds secure, well-validated RESTful APIs with FastAPI, Django, and Node.js/Express, and scalable React/Next.js frontends, backed by PostgreSQL and MongoDB. Part of the team behind Sazara, a live production Point-of-Sale system, and Elimos, a Django/React platform in final production rollout. Comfortable working in fast-paced, globally distributed teams — optimizing database performance, containerizing services with Docker for reliable deployment, and building monitoring with Prometheus/Grafana. Curious about Web3, blockchain, and emerging technologies, with a strong bias toward ownership, reliability, and continuous learning.

### TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Backend:** Python (FastAPI, Django, Flask), Node.js, Express.js, RESTful API design & debugging, authentication & authorization, secure coding practices

**Frontend:** React.js, Next.js, JavaScript, HTML5/CSS3, REST API integration

**Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB — schema design, query optimization, performance tuning

**DevOps & Reliability:** Docker (containerization & deployment), Git/GitHub, CI/CD pipelines, Linux (Ubuntu, Debian), Prometheus & Grafana, Agile workflows

**Additional:** Laravel (PHP), log analysis & root-cause troubleshooting, scalable system design

### PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

#### Software Developer (Part-Time, Remote) | Sazara, Nairobi (Jan 2025 – Present, on contract)

- Built and maintained backend services with Python (FastAPI, Django) and Node.js, exposing secure, well-validated RESTful APIs consumed by frontend clients.
- Optimized PostgreSQL and MongoDB queries and schema design for performance, scalability, and reliability.
- Containerized services with Docker for consistent, repeatable deployments, and supported CI/CD workflows to speed up releases.
- Built Prometheus/Grafana monitoring dashboards for system health and early incident detection.
- Debugged production issues end-to-end through API tracing, log analysis, and database investigation; collaborated in Agile, Git-based team workflows across a globally distributed team.

#### Software Developer | Royal Media Services (RMS), Nairobi (Jan 2026 – Apr 2026)

- Developed and maintained features for News Vault and internal CMS platforms using Laravel (PHP), supporting large-scale content and interaction data.
- Used Docker to containerize services for consistent, repeatable deployments.
- Diagnosed root causes of recurring technical issues through log and system analysis, improving service reliability.
- Collaborated with the engineering team on documentation and incident tracking processes.

### PROJECT EXPERIENCE

#### Sazara POS System — Full-Stack Production Application (pos.sazara.co.ke)

- Collaborated with a development team to design and build a scalable Point-of-Sale system using React, Next.js, and FastAPI.
- Contributed to secure authentication, transaction workflows, and data validation across the stack.

- Integrated REST APIs for real-time frontend-backend communication and helped optimize backend/database interactions for performance.
- Containerized with Docker and deployed to production; actively used in real business operations today.

#### **Elimos — Contract Project, Sazara**

- Contributed as part of a development team building a Django (Python) backend with a React frontend, currently in final stages of production rollout.
- Worked on backend API development and frontend integration alongside the team as part of a contract engagement.

#### **CMS Interaction Tracking Optimization — Royal Media Services**

- Diagnosed  $O(n^2)$  performance bottlenecks in a CMS handling large-scale interaction data and refactored the logic.
- Implemented batching and pre-aggregation strategies that reduced database load and improved throughput in production.

#### **Academic Full-Stack Projects — USIU-Africa (2023)**

- Built full-stack coursework projects using FastAPI and Django, covering backend API design and data-driven application logic.

## **EDUCATION**

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**Bachelor of Science in Information Systems and Technology** | United States International University – Africa (USIU-Africa)

## **CERTIFICATIONS**

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**Software Developer Certificate** — PLP Africa (2025)